Lula and Dilma, as demonstrated by the struggles over Tipnis, Bolivia, those in the Peruvian and Ecuadorian Amazon, in Uruguayan and Paraguayan lands, in African countries and so on, while the most essential conditions of life and work are denied the Brazilian working class.

If dependency means economies dedicated to responding to the needs of other economies and sub-imperialism means a dependent economy that not only transmits value but appropriates that of weaker countries, today as before Brazilian sub-imperialism plunders the working class subordinate to it in order to reproduce in an expanded form the plunder of its own working class. The biggest meat company in the world belongs to the bourgeoisie of a country that denies food to its people. One of the largest development banks in the world belongs to a country where half of the federal budget is intended for payment to the high finance bourgeoisie. Some of the world's biggest construction companies are part of the political class of a country where the working class lacks sanitation, good public transport and has to spend up to four hours a day going between their jobs and homes in metropolitan areas. All this validates the relevance of Marini's concluding remarks in *Subdesarrollo y revolución* [*Underdevelopment and Revolution*], which are: the sub-imperialist nature that the dependent bourgeoisie tries to imprint upon its domination should make continental anti-imperialist resistance team up with the class struggle that moves (and should move) the Brazilian working class.

Notes

1. This chapter is an amended and expanded version of the text by the same name published in *Crítica Marxista*, 36, 2013, pp 129–141.
2. See Luce 2011. A work that has Marini as a reference point for examining South African sub-imperialism is Coles and Cohen 1977.
3. In this chapter we present theoretical advances to the discussion found in my doctoral dissertation (Luce 2011) on Marini's category of sub-imperialism. I thank Jaime Osorio for his valuable comments on the ideas presented here.
4. They are: the capitalist mode of production, the capitalist world system, the pattern of capital reproduction, the socio-economic formation and the conjuncture (Osorio 2012a). See Cardoso and Serra 1979 and Marini's reply (2000).
5. For a discussion of its validity and even the increase of the working class's over-exploitation under other forms of contemporary Brazilian capitalism, see my article 'Brasil: nova classe média ou novas formas de superexploração da classe trabalhadora?' (Luce 2013).
6. There is no space in this chapter for an analysis of the differences between Marini's category of sub-imperialism and Wallerstein's semi-periphery. For now, very briefly and abstracting the theoretical and political differences between MDT and world system analyses, one can say that every sub-imperialist country is part of what used to be called the semi-periphery but not every semi-peripheral country is a sub-imperialist socio-economic formation.
7. Besides Brazil, Marini also considered South Africa and Israel among the countries that take on the condition of sub-imperialist socio-economic formations.
8. Marini laid the foundations for the category *capital reproduction pattern* that were taken